

Delegation

What you'll learn

By the end of this lesson, you'll be able to:

- Understand the Delegation competency and its three components: Problem Awareness, Platform Awareness, and Task Delegation
- Recognize when and how to delegate tasks to AI effectively
- Develop awareness of task, platform, and mode considerations when working with AI
- Apply your understanding of Delegation to a practical multi-step project you'll work on throughout the rest of this course

A closer look at delegation

Video Link: [A closer look at delegation](#)

This video explores the first core competency of AI Fluency: Delegation. We explain that Delegation focuses on deciding what work to do yourself, what to collaborate on with AI, and how to distribute tasks effectively. We go over the three key components of Delegation:

- Problem Awareness: Understanding your goals and the work involved to achieve it
- Platform Awareness: Knowing what different AI systems can do
- Task Delegation: Strategically dividing work between you and AI

We also emphasize why effective Delegation requires both expertise in your field and understanding of AI capabilities—and why it's essential for working effectively and efficiently with AI systems.

Key takeaways

- Delegation is about making thoughtful decisions about what work to do yourself, what to do together with AI, or what to let AI handle independently, and how to distribute those tasks.
- Problem Awareness means clearly understanding your goals and the nature of the work before involving AI.
- Platform Awareness involves understanding the capabilities and limitations of different AI systems.
- Task Delegation is the process of thoughtfully distributing work between humans and AI to leverage the strengths of each.
- Effective delegation requires both domain expertise and an understanding of AI capabilities.
- The goal isn't to automate everything, but to create the most effective human-AI partnership for any given task or goal.

Exercises

Analyze tasks with an AI assistant

Instructions:

1. Pick a simple task from your work or personal life (something fairly small like drafting an email, outlining a presentation, or planning a meeting or event).
2. Start a conversation with Claude
3. With Claude, share the task you are thinking about doing.
 - E.g. "Hi Claude, I'm preparing how to [insert task] and want to discuss with you what a delegation plan may look like for figuring out which parts I should delegate to an AI like you vs. not. Can you help me with this?"
4. Together, explore these questions:
 - What is the overall vision for the task? What does a good result look like?
 - What are the different bits of work needed to get there?
 - Which of these bits of work require human expertise, creativity, or judgment?
 - Note: When discussing these questions, have an actual conversation! Don't just make statements or list answers. Actually have a chat back and forth—you each may see something the other doesn't!
5. Work together to create a simple delegation plan that uses both your strengths and the AI's strengths.

Project Planning & delegation

Step 1: Choose your project

- Select a medium-sized, multi-step project that you can work on throughout the remainder of this course. Your project should be:
 - Substantial enough to involve multiple types of tasks
 - Manageable enough to complete within about 1 hour of work
 - Something you're genuinely interested in creating or accomplishing

Here are some suggestions to consider:

Communication Projects

- Create a compelling presentation on a topic you're knowledgeable about
- Write a post or series of posts explaining a complex topic to a general audience
- Develop a proposal or pitch for an idea you'd like to pursue
- Create a personal or professional bio with supporting materials

Research Projects

- Research and summarize the current state of an emerging technology or trend
- Analyze a dataset to identify patterns and create recommendations
- Compare multiple products, services, or approaches and create a recommendation
- Investigate a historical event and present your findings in an engaging format

Creative Projects

- Outline a short story with fully developed characters and plot
- Design a simple website structure with content for key pages
- Develop a concept for a product, service, or experience

Learning Projects

- Create a structured learning plan for a skill you want to develop
- Build a resource collection on a topic you're learning about
- Develop a tutorial or guide for a process you understand well
- Create a set of study materials for a topic you want to master

Step 2: Project vision and goals

Start a conversation with Claude. Share your project idea and invite Claude to ask you some questions until you feel you have a solid vision for the final result. Work together until you have a clear picture of:

- What success looks like for your project
- What would make this project particularly valuable or meaningful to you

Step 3: Task breakdown and delegation analysis

Similar to what you did in the previous lesson, work with Claude to explore your project through the lens of Delegation:

1. Identify together the major tasks needed to complete your project.
2. For each task, one at a time, discuss:
 - What specific skills, knowledge, or AI capabilities are needed?
 - Which parts would benefit from uniquely human strengths?
 - Which parts could leverage AI capabilities well?
 - Where might collaboration have the most impact?
 - Note: Again, have a genuine conversation about these questions rather than just exchanging statements. Challenge assumptions, ask for clarification, and remain open to unexpected insights that emerge during your discussion.
3. Create a project plan that includes your major tasks and delegation decisions.
4. Save your project plan—you'll return to this project later in the course to practice your Description, Discernment, and Diligence skills.

Reflection

Before moving on, take a moment to consider:

- What insights emerged from your planning conversation with Claude?
- What do you anticipate will be the most challenging aspect of your delegation plan?
- What additional information or skills might help you delegate more effectively to AI?

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